

Screen Time, Two Deletions

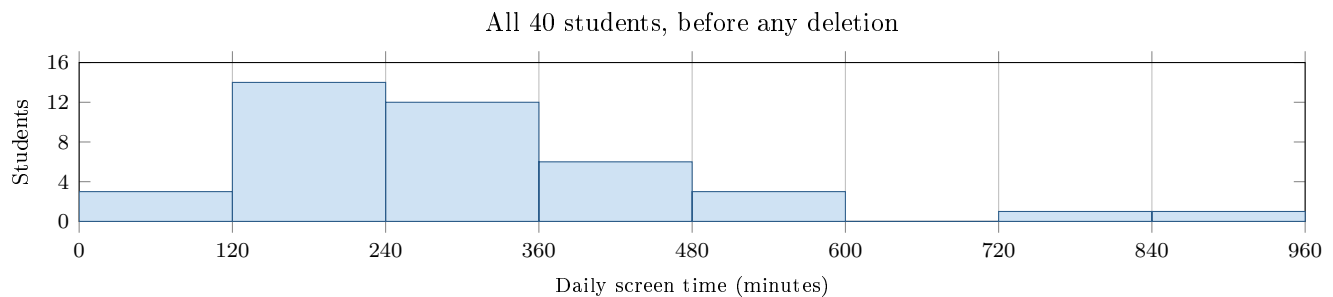
AP Statistics · Unit 1 · Topics 1.1–1.7 (CED 1.1–1.7)

[STAR] THE PROBLEM

A school nurse recorded, for a random sample of 40 students, three things: grade level (Freshman or Senior), the device they use most (Phone, Laptop, or Console), and daily screen time in minutes from the phone's own report. The principal asked one question: *Is too much screen time a concern for our students?* The nurse's first report said only: *12 of the 40 are over 240, that is 30%, so yes.*

Group sizes: 25 freshmen, 15 seniors. Over 240 minutes: 9 freshmen, 3 seniors.

The two largest values in the histogram (a 900-minute and a 720-minute entry) came from two students who logged a whole weekend by mistake. The nurse deleted both and re-computed: the mean fell from 205 to 178 minutes; the median moved from 176 to 174 minutes; the headline became *10 of 38 are over 240, that is 26%.*



FIRST TAKE — one sentence before you work the parts

Before any calculation: does the nurse's first sentence answer the principal's question? Name one thing the sentence leaves out.

[BOOK] RULES YOU MUST USE (NO ANSWERS HERE)

A number means nothing until you say WHO was measured, WHAT was measured, the UNITS, and the QUESTION it answers.

Individuals are the things measured; variables are the characteristics recorded. A label or ID is not a measurement.

Groups of different sizes are compared with relative frequencies (percents), never raw counts alone.

A full description names shape, center, variability, AND unusual features. Some statistics resist unusual values; some do not.

Work (a)–(d).

DOK 1 (a) Fill the table: who or what are the individuals, and for each recorded variable, what ONE value looks like and whether it is categorical or quantitative. Checklist: an individual is one thing measured; a name, label, or ID is not a measurement; quantitative values could sensibly be averaged.

Individuals:		
Variable	One value looks like	Categorical / Quantitative
Grade level		
Device used most		
Daily screen time		

DOK 2 (b) A senior says: *Nine freshmen are over 240 and only three seniors are, so freshmen are three times as bad.* Fix the comparison. Frame: *Of the _____ freshmen, _____ are over 240, which is _____%. Of the _____ seniors, _____ are over 240, which is _____%. So the fair comparison is _____ because the groups _____.* Then explain in one sentence why the count 9 versus 3 can mislead here.

DOK 2 (c) Deleting the two values moved the mean by 27 minutes and the median by 2 minutes. Which of these two statistics is resistant to unusual values? Explain what in the histogram caused the big move, using the words *resistant* and *unusual values*. Do not say which one the nurse should report yet.

DOK 3 (d) ★ Judge the nurse's trimmed report in three to five sentences. Use the frame below if it helps.

To earn an E, your answer must do ALL of these (some = P; one or none = I):

- ☐ Put the 26% in context: who was counted, what was measured (with units), the question it answers.
- ☐ Name the center to report and justify it with resistance, matching your answer in (c).
- ☐ Explain why the mean moved a lot while the median barely moved.
- ☐ Judge whether deleting the two values was responsible and what the report must SAY about them.

Frame: I would report _____ because _____; removing the two values changed _____ much more than _____, so the principal should _____.

which statistic your reason which statistic what you would do

Word bank: median · it resists unusual values · mode · mean · it follows unusual values · omit the deletion details · disclose and justify the deletions Some words are not needed.

Turn this sheet in whenever you finish — bonus credit. Part (d) is scored E / P / I.